

Guo Xiaochen

Room 1901, Houfu Mansion, Queen's Road West, Central and Western
District, Hong Kong SAR, China

(+86)159-5275-0242 201010012@smail.nju.edu.cn

EDUCATION

Nanjing University, Faculty of Arts

Sept 2020- Jun 2024

B.A. in Chinese Language and Literature (GPA:86/100)

Relevant Coursework: Yearly Thesis (90), Writing (95), Modern and Contemporary Chinese Literature (87), Topics in Regional Literature Studies (86), Selected Readings in New Literature (89), Classical Chinese (87), Classical Verse Metrics and Writing (86), Modern Chinese (90), Studies on Dream of the Red Chamber (89), Du Fu Studies (93), Foreign Literature (93), Eileen Chang Studies (86), Chinese Literary Criticism (87), Introduction to Literature (87), Introduction to Linguistics (90), Urban Language Survey (88), English Rhetoric and Writing (88), Basic English Writing (88), English Speech Training (94), Translation Theory and Practice (89), Drama and Humanities (92), News Commentary (96)

The University of Hong Kong, Faculty of Arts

Sept 2024- Dec 2025

M.A. in Chinese Language and Literature (GPA:3.3/4.3)

Relevant Coursework: Master's Thesis (A-), Hong Kong Literature (B+), Modern and Contemporary Chinese Literature (A-), Ci and Qu Poetry Studies (A-), Classical Fiction (B+), Chinese Dialectology (B+)

PUBLICATIONS

"Time, Perspective, Space: The Narrative Construction of Color Imagery in Eileen Chang's *The Golden Cangue*" 2026

"World Chinese Literary Forum" (CSSCI Expanded Source Journal), Accepted, scheduled for publication in 2026

"The Evolution and Cultural Interpretation of Yangzhou Depictions in Song Ci Poetry" Jan 2026

"Journal of Baoding University", Accepted, scheduled for publication in Issue 1, 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

New Research on Verbal Impoliteness: A Case Study of "Border Town" | Nanjing University

Jul 2020 – Mar 2021

Supervisor: Prof. Chen Lizhong, School of Liberal Arts, Nanjing University; Expert, Hunan Provincial New Century 121 Talent Project

- This paper received the 26th Nanjing University Basic Disciplines Thesis Award.
- Conducted a literature review of domestic and international verbal impoliteness research over recent decades. Defined research concepts based on four principles: intention, appropriateness, tone, and morality. Re-examined the emotional, humorous, harmonious, coercive, and labor-saving functions of language through analysis of character dialogues in "Border Town".

American Literature Research Based on the Historical Context of Marxist Dissemination | Nanjing University

Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

Supervisor: Prof. Yang Jincai, School of Foreign Studies, Nanjing University; Member, TESOL Expert Committee

- This project was rated as a National Undergraduate Innovation Program and was invited to the 4th High-End Forum on Contemporary English Literature in China, hosted by Renmin University of China.
- Project deliverables included 3 academic papers, 3 mid-term research reports, 9 reading notes, and 25 key literature reviews and public articles. Explored the similarities and differences in Marxist thought within the works of three American writers (Jack London, Theodore Dreiser, John Steinbeck) and conducted in-depth research into the characteristics of their respective works.

Urban Language Survey: Language Competence Survey in the AI Era | Nanjing University

Apr 2022 – Jan 2023

Supervisor: Prof. Wang Ling, School of Liberal Arts, Nanjing University; Researcher, China Language Strategy Research Center, Ministry of Education

- Collaborated with team members in the preliminary research phase to design a language ability questionnaire for the AI era.

Utilized semi-structured interviews. Three rounds of surveys collected 176 valid samples. The resulting individual paper explored the intrinsic connections between urban language environments, family language planning, and language development status, providing a factual basis for dialect inheritance research and planning.

A Study on the Narrative Strategies of Imagery Clusters in Mo Yan's Novels from the Perspective of Hallucinatory Realism
| Nanjing University **Dec 2023 – May 2024**

Supervisor: Prof. Yuan Wenzhuo, School of Liberal Arts, Nanjing University; Deputy Secretary-General, Qixia District Writers Association, Nanjing

- This paper first clarified the concepts of hallucinatory realism and related theoretical terms. It then explored Mo Yan's inheritance and deviation from the Chinese narrative tradition. Subsequently, it demonstrated Mo Yan's construction of multi-dimensional virtual narrative spaces within and beyond the text, and the existence of the "implied author," through the analysis of imagery clusters related to alcohol, animals, colors, and violence.

Urban Metaphors in Tête-bêche Narrative: The Spatial Aesthetics of Liu Yichang's Texts | The University of Hong Kong
Sep 2024 – Dec 2024

Supervisor: Prof. Lin Pei-yin, Head of School, School of Chinese, The University of Hong Kong; Associate Professor of Modern and Contemporary Chinese Literature; Harvard-Yenching Visiting Scholar, 2016

- Based on spatial narrative theory, this paper selected Liu Yichang's "Tête-bêche" as the research object. It explored how the novel's tête-bêche dual narrative structure, linguistic experimentation, and construction of textual space reflect the cultural metaphors of Hong Kong's urban space, as well as the interaction between individuals and urban space, particularly the dual writing of women and the city.

A Study of Characters in "Dream of the Red Chamber": The Case of Qianxue | The University of Hong Kong
Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Supervisor: Prof. Lai Hing-fong, Lecturer, Associate Professor, Chu Hai College of Higher Education; Deputy Head of Academic Division, Hong Kong Writers' Association

- This paper builds upon previous research to explore the character of Qianxue from three perspectives: her identity, her name, and her narrative function. It attempts to move beyond the mainstream focus on central characters in Redology (the study of Dream of the Red Chamber) by shifting attention to a marginal yet semantically rich figure who receives relatively little description in the text.

Postcolonial Identity Writing in "The Exorcist": Body, Space, and Time | The University of Hong Kong
Dec 2024 – Mar 2025

Supervisor: Prof. Leung Suk Man, School of Chinese, The University of Hong Kong; Recipient of the Outstanding Young Researcher Scheme

- Using "The Exorcist" as the core text and incorporating postcolonial theories such as colonial legacy, cultural hybridity, and ghost writing, this paper examined how Shi Shuqing reveals the identity paradox of postcolonial Hong Kong through multiple dimensions of space, symbols, body, and time: its attachment to the material symbols of colonial heritage while attempting to recall suppressed local memories within the diasporic experience; its use of "ghost writing" to summon historical trauma while being constrained by cultural aphasia in the context of modernity.

A Study of the Ru Tone in Yangzhou Dialect: Diachronic, Synchronic, and Empirical | The University of Hong Kong
Jan 2025 – May 2025

Supervisor: Prof. Richard Van Ness SIMMONS, School of Chinese, The University of Hong Kong; Tenured Professor (former), Department of Asian Languages and Cultures, Rutgers, The State University of New Jersey, USA

- This paper analyzed ancient texts like "Guangyun" and contemporary literature such as the "Yangzhou Fangyan Cidian" and "Hanyu Fangyin Zihui". It innovatively conducted a comparative study of the performances of the same text, "Wu Song Fights the Tiger", by renowned Yangzhou Pinghua artist Wang Shaotang (1889-1968) and the fifth-generation inheritor of the Wang school, Ma Wei (1980-). This enabled a diachronic, synchronic, and empirical study of the Ru tone in the Yangzhou dialect,

attempting to reveal the unique role of linguistic art forms in the process of sound change and providing theoretical support and practical solutions for the revitalization and inheritance of endangered dialects.

Diaspora and Belonging: Examining Ge Liang's Hong Kong Writing through the Lens of Spatial Narrative | The University of Hong Kong

Sep 2024 – Aug 2025

Supervisor: Prof. Wei Yan, Assistant Professor of Modern and Contemporary Chinese Literature, The University of Hong Kong; Ph.D. in East Asian Languages and Civilizations, Harvard University

- Set against the backdrop of modern Cantonese-Hong Kong history, Ge Liang's *Food is Heaven* employs spatial narrative to depict the cultural practices and identity dilemmas of diasporic individuals. This research integrates diaspora literature, narratology, spatial theory, and postcolonial theory to discuss the experience of diaspora and spatial mobility from multiple angles. It proceeds to systematically categorize the spaces within *Food is Heaven*, analyzes the spatial strategies used in constructing a sense of belonging, and finally explores the distinctive characteristics of Ge Liang's portrayal of Hong Kong.

The Cyborg City and Human Alienation in Hong Kong Literature | Nanyang Technological University

Aug 2025 – Nov 2025

Supervisor: Prof. Yow Cheun Hoe, Chinese Programme, Nanyang Technological University; Director, Chinese Heritage Centre; Director, Centre for Chinese Language and Culture

- This project was prepared for application to the 2026 Biennial Conference of Chinese and Comparative Literature. The application result will be announced on Dec 20.
- This paper focused on Hong Kong literature's response to the posthuman condition under techno-capitalism. Using works by Hon Lai Chu, Dorothy Tse, and Dung Kai-cheung as case studies, it explored how they portray Hong Kong as a massive "cyborg" city and profoundly depict the state of human alienation within it. These literary practices, with their unique local specificity and critical nature, provide an important humanistic perspective on global technological anxiety and seek possibilities for redemption within the landscape of alienation.

EXCHANGE EXPERIENCE

The Chinese University of Hong Kong | Program Participant

Jun 2023

Successfully completed the thesis: "Research on Art Creation from the Perspective of Rural Revitalization." Praised by the university for "strong learning observation and research innovation abilities." Awarded 2023 Outstanding Camper.

University of Oxford | Summer Exchange

Aug 2023

Served as Group Leader, completing all complex tasks including case studies, field research, and PPT design. Awarded the Best Academic Presentation Award. Received a book gifted with the signature of the President.

CAMPUS ACTIVITIES & INTERNSHIPS

Student Clubs

Management member of the "Dream of the Red Chamber" club. Assisted Prof. Wu Lisong from the School of History in script creation. Organized activities imitating character makeup and Hanfu attire.

Jul 2021 – Dec 2021

Secretary-General of the Nanjing University Football Association. Assisted in organizing competition events. Responsible for recording daily match results and operating the public account.

Sep 2021 – Sep 2022

Member of the Nanjing University Psychology Association. Participated in the creation and filming of a sitcom. Awarded Second Prize in the annual drama competition.

Feb 2022 – Sep 2022

Internships & Social Practice

Invited as a student representative of Nanjing University to record for the "Yuhuatai Forum" program at Nanjing Radio and Television Station.

Jan 2022

Editor-in-Chief at the Nanjing University Career Center New Media Department. Responsible for operating a public account with hundreds of thousands of followers.

Mar 2022 – Mar 2023

Participated in an internship program organized by the Asia-Pacific Exchange Center of China International Publishing Group.

Received English translation skills training. Completed over 4800 words of translation.

Mar 2023 – May 2023

Served as a Companion Mentor at Xinzhi Pengbei Company, assisting adolescents in achieving comprehensive development.

Apr 2024 – Sep 2025

Volunteer Activities

Co-founded the Nanjing University Disability Support Organization with eight other students. Operated the organization's public website.

Aug 2021 – Sep 2022

Participated in an international volunteer activity organized by "Teach for China," providing remote teaching to primary school students in Guangxi.

Feb 2023 – Jun 2023

Participated in the Nanjing University "Reading Together" volunteer program, completing reading tasks with primary school students in Gansu.

Apr 2023 – Jul 2023

SKILLS

Chinese (Native), English (IELTS 7.5), Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), Photography, Interviewing, Debate, Pipa (Chinese lute)